

A WORKING ANSWER TO MENTELLA HEALTH'S APPLICATION TASK

Welcome Copilot

HR tracks hiring in a shared Google Sheet. When a row turns “Hired”, this system sends the welcome email, keeps proof of every send, and alerts a human the moment anything stops working. It is running live right now.

Live demo: <https://welcome-copilot.vercel.app>

Source: <https://github.com/avertec0773/welcome-copilot>

An unofficial demo built by one applicant. All people and policies are fictional, and every recipient address is a + alias of the author's own inbox. Every screenshot in this document is taken from the live system, unedited except for cropping.

The question, and the shape of the answer

“Sketch how you would automate the welcome email (tracked in a shared spreadsheet several people edit): what you’d use, what could go wrong, and how you’d know if it silently stopped working.”

Instead of a one-page sketch, this is a working system. The written sketch still exists (`docs/sketch.md` in the repo), but every claim in it can be checked against a live deployment.

What it uses

Google Apps Script bound to the team’s existing shared Sheet, on a 5-minute trigger. No new tool for HR to learn: the spreadsheet stays the source of truth, and the automation works around how the team already works. A small Next.js console on Vercel gives everyone a read-only window into the pipeline, plus a Claude-backed assistant that answers new-hire questions from the onboarding handbook.

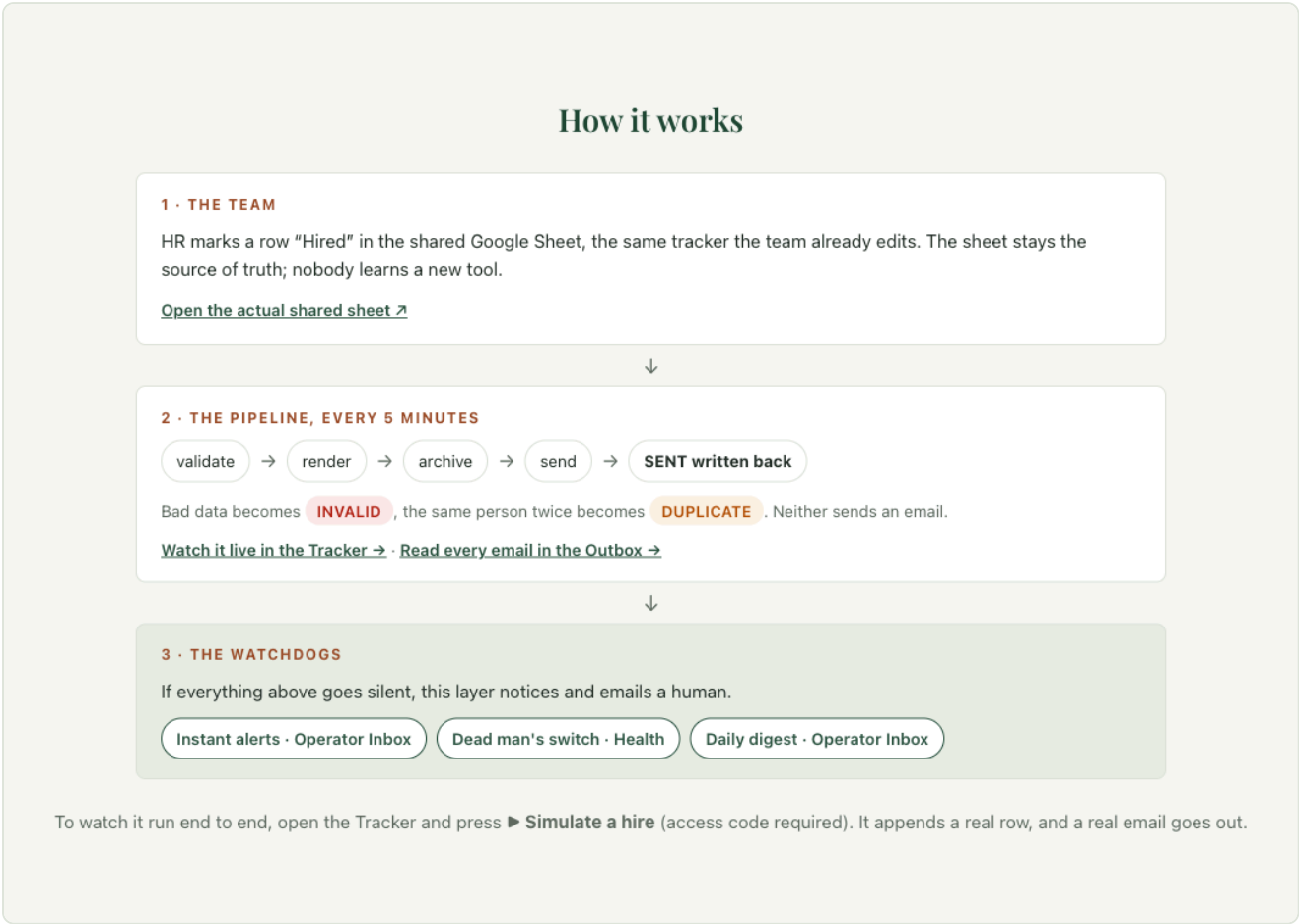
What could go wrong, by design

- A typo’d email address → the row is marked **INVALID** before any email leaves.
- The same person pasted twice → the second row is marked **DUPLICATE** ; only the first may ever send.
- A re-sorted sheet mid-run → every write is keyed by hire ID, not row position, so results land on the right person.
- A crash between “sending” and “sent” → a SENDING marker stays visible for a human to review; it is never auto-retried into a double send.
- Gmail’s daily quota running out → the pipeline holds sends and says so, rather than failing quietly.

How you’d know it silently stopped

Three independent alarms: instant error emails to the operator, a dead-man’s switch (`healthchecks.io`) that alerts on *silence* rather than on errors, and a daily digest with the bottom line. The failures that cannot report themselves are exactly what the dead-man’s switch exists for.

Three lanes: the team, the pipeline, the watchdogs



The landing page walks a visitor through the same three lanes. Each chip links to the console page where that stage is visible.

Component	Job
Google Sheets (shared)	Source of truth. HR edits it directly; the pipeline writes results back into it.
Google Apps Script	The pipeline: validate, render, archive, send, every 5 minutes under a script lock.
Gmail	Delivery. Every send is archived to an Outbox tab before it leaves.
Next.js on Vercel	Read-only console over the live sheet, plus the gated Simulate write path.
Claude (Haiku)	The onboarding assistant: retrieval over 9 handbook docs, citations, honest refusals.
Upstash Redis	Rate limits, every one of them shown to the visitor with a live remaining count.
healthchecks.io	Dead-man's switch: the pipeline pings it every run; silence raises an alert.

The Tracker is the sheet, live

Mentella Hiring Tracker (Demo)

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help

100%

View only

hire_id	name	email	license	state	start_date	manager	status	welcome_sent_at	welcome_status	error_detail	is_demo	applied_on	interviewed_on
H-0001	Maria Chen	ayetek0773+maria@gmail.com	LMFT	CA	8/3/2026	Dana Whitfield	Onboarded	7/20/2026	SENT		FALSE	2026-06-18	2026-06-18
H-0002	James Okafor	ayetek0773+james@gmail.com	LCSW	NY	8/10/2026	Dana Whitfield	Onboarded	7/27/2026	SENT		FALSE	2026-06-25	2026-07-01
H-0003	Sarah Kim	ayetek0773+sarah@gmail.com	LPC	TX	9/1/2026	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/18/2026	SENT		FALSE	2026-07-14	2026-07-14
H-0004	Priya Natarajan	ayetek0773+priya@gmail.com	LPCC	CA	9/14/2026	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/29/2026	SENT		FALSE	2026-08-05	2026-08-05
H-0005	Daniel Reyes	daniel.reyes@	PsyD	FL	9/14/2026	Dana Whitfield	Hired		INVALID	invalid email	FALSE	2026-08-06	2026-08-06
H-0006	Emily Tran	ayetek0773+emily@gmail.com	LMFT	WA	9/21/2026	Luis Herrera	Offer				FALSE	2026-08-12	2026-08-12
H-0007	Marcus Bell	ayetek0773+marcus@gmail.com	LCSW	IL	10/5/2026	Dana Whitfield	Offer				FALSE	2026-08-15	2026-08-15
H-0008	Hannah Roth	ayetek0773+hannah@gmail.com	LPC	CO			Interviewing				FALSE	2026-08-19	2026-08-19
H-0009	Deshawn Carter	ayetek0773+deshawn@gmail.com	LMFT	GA			Interviewing				FALSE	2026-08-21	2026-08-21
H-0010	Alina Petrova	ayetek0773+alina@gmail.com	PsyD	NJ			Interviewing				FALSE	2026-08-24	2026-08-24
H-0011	Sarah Kim	ayetek0773+sarah@gmail.com	LPC	TX	9/1/2026	Luis Herrera	Hired		DUPLICATE	duplicate of	FALSE	2026-07-14	2026-07-14
H-0012	Demo Jordan	ayetek0773+demo-80f714@gmail.com	LCSW	TX	2026-09-13	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/29/2026	SENT		TRUE	2026-08-16	2026-08-16
H-0013	Demo Ping	ayetek0773+demo-a31068@gmail.com	LPCC	IL	2026-09-13	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/30/2026	SENT		TRUE	2026-08-16	2026-08-16
H-0014	Demo Echo	ayetek0773+demo-d8d54b@gmail.com	LPC	WA	2026-09-13	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/30/2026	SENT		TRUE	2026-08-16	2026-08-16
H-0015	Demo Alex	ayetek0773+demo-eee508@gmail.com	LMFT	CO	2026-09-13	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/30/2026	SENT		TRUE	2026-08-16	2026-08-16
H-0016	Nova	ayetek0773+demo-029679@gmail.com	LPC	TX	2026-09-13	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/30/2026	SENT		TRUE	2026-07-31	2026-08-01
H-0017	Avery	ayetek0773+demo-c52bc7@gmail.com	LMFT	NY	2026-09-13	Luis Herrera	Hired	8/30/2026	SENT		TRUE	2026-07-31	2026-08-01

The actual shared Sheet, publicly viewable. Script-managed columns (welcome_sent_at, status, error) sit beside HR's own columns. Rows H-0005 and H-0011 are broken on purpose so both guards stay visible.

Welcome Copilot

Ops console Demo - fictional data

Unlocked

Open the shared Google Sheet

Tracker

Outbox

Operator Inbox

Health

Assistant

Tracker

Refreshed 12:00:17 PM

Simulate a hire

This is the same shared sheet HR edits, read live. The pipeline watches the Status column, and the Welcome email column is where it writes its result back. Click a row for the full candidate story.

SENT

 delivered once

DRAFTED

 dry run only

SENDING

 mid-send, human reviews

INVALID

 bad data, not sent

DUPLICATE

 only the first sends

ID	Name	Welcome email	Status	Start	License	State	Email
H-0001	Maria Chen	SENT	Onboarded	Aug 3, 2026	LMFT	CA	ayetek0773+maria@gmail.com
H-0002	James Okafor	SENT	Onboarded	Aug 10, 2026	LCSW	NY	ayetek0773+james@gmail.com
H-0003	Sarah Kim	SENT	Hired	Sep 1, 2026	LPC	TX	ayetek0773+sarah@gmail.com
H-0004	Priya Natarajan	SENT	Hired	Sep 14, 2026	LPCC	CA	ayetek0773+priya@gmail.com
H-0005	Daniel Reyes	INVALID	Hired	Sep 14, 2026	PsyD	FL	daniel.reyes@
H-0006	Emily Tran	—	Offer	Sep 21, 2026	LMFT	WA	ayetek0773+emily@gmail.com

The console reads the same sheet. One line of legend, then the data. Any row expands into the full candidate story: applied, interviewed, offer, start, notes, and what the pipeline did about it.

Proof of every send, and a pipeline that reports to its operator

Welcome Copilot Ops console Demo - fictional data Unlocked Open the shared Google Sheet ↗

Tracker **Outbox** Operator Inbox Health Assistant

Outbox

Every email, archived the moment it was rendered

- What you read here is exactly what the recipient got.
- LIVE means it was actually sent. DRAFT means a dry-run rehearsal that never left.
- The archive is written before the send, so even a failed send leaves evidence.
- The run log on the Health page records whether each archived email actually left.

ayetek0773+demo-e792db@gmail.com Welcome to Mentella, Riley! 8/30/2026 11:59:48	LIVE
ayetek0773+demo-c52bc7@gmail.com Welcome to Mentella, Avery! 8/30/2026 11:51:12	LIVE
ayetek0773+demo-029679@gmail.com Welcome to Mentella, Nova! 8/30/2026 0:58:42	LIVE
ayetek0773+demo-eee508@gmail.com Welcome to Mentella, Demo! 8/30/2026 0:16:38	LIVE
ayetek0773+demo-d8d54b@gmail.com Welcome to Mentella, Demo! 8/30/2026 0:14:54	LIVE
ayetek0773+demo-a31068@gmail.com Welcome to Mentella, Demo! 8/30/2026 0:12:42	LIVE
ayetek0773+demo-	LIVE

Welcome to Mentella, Riley! · to ayetek0773+demo-e792db@gmail.com · 8/30/2026 11:59:48

Welcome to Mentella Health, Riley!

We are thrilled to have you joining our clinical team in CA. Your first day is **Saturday, September 12, 2026**.

A few things to know before you start:

- Your manager:** Luis Herrera will reach out this week to schedule your first check-in.
- Credentialing:** we have your LPC on file and will confirm state paperwork before day one.
- Questions?** Our [New Therapist Assistant](#) answers the questions new hires ask most: scheduling, EHR access, payroll, PTO, and more.

If anything here looks wrong, just reply to this email.

Warmly,
Mentella People Ops
people-ops@mentella.example

The Outbox: every email archived at the moment it was rendered, before the send. What you read here is exactly what the recipient got.

Welcome Copilot Ops console Demo - fictional data Unlocked Open the shared Google Sheet ↗

Tracker Outbox **Operator Inbox** Health Assistant

Operator Inbox

The emails the pipeline sends its own operator

- Instant alerts the moment something needs a human, and a daily digest at 8:00.
- A quiet inbox here, plus a green dead-man's switch on the Health page, means things are genuinely fine.

Daily digest	DIGEST	Daily digest
8/30/2026 10:11:48		8/30/2026 10:11:48
Duplicate line row H-0011 8/30/2026 10:11:48	ALERT	welcome-copilot pipeline, last 24h: Emails sent: 6 Demo sends today: 5 Drafts created (dry-run): 1 Invalid rows: 1 Duplicate rows: 1 Pipeline errors: 0 Runs skipped (lock busy): 0 Runs hitting quota floor: 0 Rows stuck in SENDING (need review): 0 Mail quota remaining today: 90 No news from me tomorrow would itself be a signal. Check the triggers.
Invalid line row H-0005 8/30/2026 10:16:43	ALERT	

The Operator Inbox: the alert and digest emails the pipeline sends its human.

Welcome Copilot Ops console Demo - fictional data Unlocked Open the shared Google Sheet ↗

Tracker Outbox Operator Inbox **Health** Assistant

Health

Three ways to notice a failure

- Alert emails fire the moment something needs a human. They land in the Operator Inbox.
- The dead-man's switch badge below watches for silence itself, which catches the failures that can't report themselves.
- The daily digest is the bottom line a human actually reads, once a day.
- The run log below shows every time the pipeline woke up and what it did.

Last pipeline run 1 min ago Red? Check the Apps Script triggers, then the RUNBOOK.	Mode LIVE LIVE sends real email; DRY-RUN only drafts.	Mail quota left today 88 Email allows ~100/day; the pipeline holds sends below 20 left.	Dead man's switch Healthcheck: OK Alerts fire when the pipeline goes silent, whatever the cause.	Assistant budget 300/day Free-form answers are capped; suggested questions are coaxed.
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Recent pipeline runs

11:51 AM - woke up, found 3 eligible: sent 1, flagged 1 duplicate, 1 invalid
11:49 AM - woke up, found 2 eligible: flagged 1 duplicate, 1 invalid
11:44 AM - woke up, found 2 eligible: flagged 1 duplicate, 1 invalid
11:39 AM - woke up, found 2 eligible: flagged 1 duplicate, 1 invalid
11:34 AM - woke up, found 2 eligible: flagged 1 duplicate, 1 invalid
11:29 AM - woke up, found 2 eligible: flagged 1 duplicate, 1 invalid

Health: last run, mode, mail quota, the dead-man's switch badge, and a plain-English run log.

An assistant that cites its sources, and admits what it doesn't know

When is my first paycheck, and how do I set up direct deposit?

Your first paycheck arrives on the first scheduled payday after your start date [2]. Mentella pays semi-monthly on the 15th and the last business day of each month [2].

To receive it, set up direct deposit in your Paylocity profile during your first week; it's a day-1 checklist item [1][3]. You can add up to 3 accounts and split pay by percentage or fixed amount [1]. Once you complete your direct deposit setup in Paylocity, your first paycheck will be paid out by direct deposit [2]. If you start mid-period, that first check is prorated to the days you actually worked [2].

cached answer

▼ Sources (3)

[1] Payroll and Paylocity · Setting up direct deposit · updated 2026-08-01
Set up direct deposit in your Paylocity profile during your first week — it's one of three items on the day-1 checklist alongside tax forms and your emergency contact. You can add up to 3 accounts and split pay by percen...

[2] Payroll and Paylocity · Pay schedule (semi-monthly) · updated 2026-08-01
Mentella pays semi-monthly: on the 15th and on the last business day of each month, covering the two halves of that month. If the 15th falls on a weekend or holiday, pay moves to the prior business day. Salaried clinicia...

[3] Your First Week at Mentella · Day 1 — accounts · updated 2026-08-01
Sign in to your @mentella.example Google account and set up 2-step verification (required within 48 hours). Complete your Paylocity profile: direct deposit, tax forms, and emergency contact.

The handbook

The 9 docs the assistant reads. Open any of them and compare with its answers.

- Billing and Insurance Basics
- EHR Access and Accounts
- HIPAA Do's and Don'ts
- IT and Account Support
- Payroll and Paylocity cited in the last answer**
- PTO and Leave
- Scheduling with Calendly
- Supervision and Licensure
- Your First Week at Mentella cited in the last answer**

Ask about onboarding, payroll, PTO, EHR access...

Ask

Every answer carries numbered citations, and the handbook docs it drew from light up in the right rail. A reader can open the doc and check the answer against the source on the spot.

verification (required within 48 hours). Complete your Paylocity profile: direct deposit, tax forms, and emergency contact.

What is the guest wifi password at the office?

I'm not sure about the guest wifi password. The handbook excerpts I have cover VPN and security requirements, but don't include wifi passwords or network credentials.

Please reach out to ops@mentella.example for that information, or check the IT Hub portal, which is Mentella's single portal for IT requests and general tickets [1].

► Sources (3)

Ask about onboarding, payroll, PTO, EHR access...

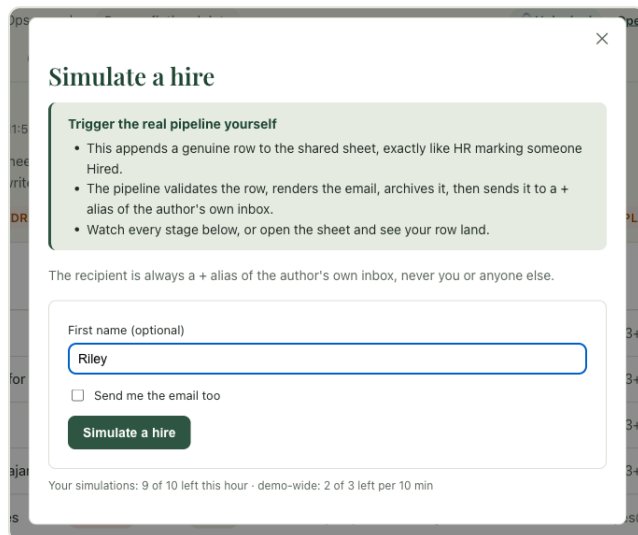
Ask

Asked something the handbook doesn't cover, it says so and points to a human instead of guessing.

Press the button, watch the real pipeline run

The console's only write path: Simulate appends a genuine row to the shared sheet, exactly like HR marking someone Hired, then nudges the pipeline. Everything that follows is the same code path a real hire gets. Every screenshot on these two pages comes from real runs made while writing this document.

STEP 1 · THE FORM (LIMITS SHOWN, NEVER SILENT)



Simulate a hire

Trigger the real pipeline yourself

- This appends a genuine row to the shared sheet, exactly like HR marking someone Hired.
- The pipeline validates the row, renders the email, archives it, then sends it to a + alias of the author's own inbox.
- Watch every stage below, or open the sheet and see your row land.

The recipient is always a + alias of the author's own inbox, never you or anyone else.

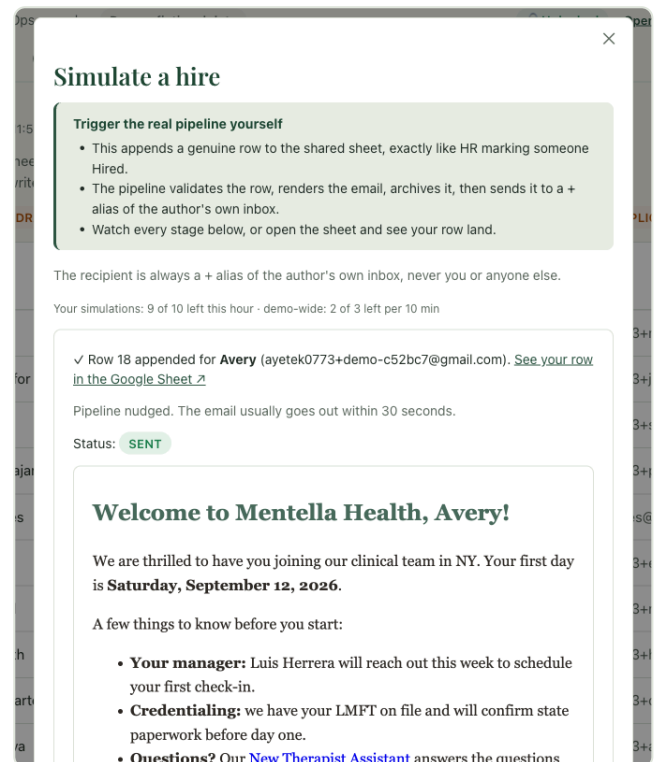
First name (optional)

☐ Send me the email too

Simulate a hire

Your simulations: 9 of 10 left this hour · demo-wide: 2 of 3 left per 10 min

STEP 2 · ROW APPENDED, PIPELINE RUNS, EMAIL RENDERED



Simulate a hire

Trigger the real pipeline yourself

- This appends a genuine row to the shared sheet, exactly like HR marking someone Hired.
- The pipeline validates the row, renders the email, archives it, then sends it to a + alias of the author's own inbox.
- Watch every stage below, or open the sheet and see your row land.

The recipient is always a + alias of the author's own inbox, never you or anyone else.

Your simulations: 9 of 10 left this hour · demo-wide: 2 of 3 left per 10 min

✓ Row 18 appended for **Avery** (ayetek0773+demo-c52bc7@gmail.com). [See your row in the Google Sheet ↗](#)

Pipeline nudged. The email usually goes out within 30 seconds.

Status: **SENT**

Welcome to Mentella Health, Avery!

We are thrilled to have you joining our clinical team in NY. Your first day is **Saturday, September 12, 2026**.

A few things to know before you start:

- **Your manager:** Luis Herrera will reach out this week to schedule your first check-in.
- **Credentialing:** we have your LMFT on file and will confirm state paperwork before day one.
- **Questions?** Our [New Therapist Assistant](#) answers the questions

The row in the sheet, the email in a real inbox

STEP 3 · THE SAME ROW, IN THE ACTUAL SHARED SHEET

H-0012	Demo Jordan	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LCSW	TX	ayetek0773+demo-80f714@gmail.com
H-0013	Demo Ping	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LPCC	IL	ayetek0773+demo-a31068@gmail.com
H-0014	Demo Echo	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LPC	WA	ayetek0773+demo-d8d54b@gmail.com
H-0015	Demo Alex	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LMFT	CO	ayetek0773+demo-eee508@gmail.com
H-0016	Nova	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LPC	TX	ayetek0773+demo-029679@gmail.com
H-0017	Avery	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LMFT	NY	ayetek0773+demo-c52bc7@gmail.com
H-0018	Riley	SENT	Hired	Sep 13, 2026	LPC	CA	ayetek0773+demo-e792db@gmail.com

Applied **Jul 31, 2026** → Interviewed **Aug 16, 2026** → Offer **Aug 23, 2026** → Starts **Sep 13, 2026**

Hire ID: H-0018 License: LPC State: CA Manager: Luis Herrera Email: ayetek0773+demo-e792db@gmail.com

Created by a demo visitor via Simulate

Welcome email: **SENT**

How a row becomes a sent email

Interviewing → Offer → **Hired** → pipeline, every 5 min → validate → render → archive → send → **SENT**

A row that fails validation is marked INVALID. A second row with the same email is marked DUPLICATE. Two rows above are broken on purpose so you can watch both guards fire.

STEP 4 · THE EMAIL, DELIVERED TO A REAL GMAIL INBOX

Welcome to Mentella, Riley!

Mentella People Ops <ayetek0773@gmail.com>
to ayetek0773+demo-e792db

11:59 AM (2 minutes ago)

Welcome to Mentella Health, Riley!

We are thrilled to have you joining our clinical team in CA. Your first day is **Saturday, September 12, 2026**.

A few things to know before you start:

- **Your manager:** Luis Herrera will reach out this week to schedule your first check-in.
- **Credentialing:** we have your LPC on file and will confirm state paperwork before day one.
- **Questions?** Our [New Therapist Assistant](#) answers the questions new hires ask most: scheduling, EHR access, payroll, PTO, and more.

If anything here looks wrong, just reply to this email.

Warmly,
Mentella People Ops
people-ops@mentella.example

Reply Forward

Recipient addresses are + aliases of the author’s own inbox, so the demo sends real email without ever emailing a stranger. Demo rows are tagged, counted separately in the daily digest, and archived automatically after 7 days.

Why it never sends twice, and never fails quietly

The invariants

- **Idempotent by record, not by memory.** The sheet itself records every send. A row with a `welcome_sent_at` timestamp will never send again, whatever else happens.
- **At-most-once sending.** A `SENDING` marker is written and flushed before Gmail is called. If the script dies mid-send, the marker stays for a human; it is never auto-retried.
- **Writes keyed by hire ID.** Every write-back verifies the row still holds the same hire ID, so a re-sorted sheet cannot misdirect a result.
- **Fail closed.** Anything other than an explicit `dry_run = FALSE` means rehearsal mode: drafts, not sends.

The three alarms

Alarm	Catches	Latency
Instant alert emails	Errors the pipeline can see and report	Immediate
Dead-man's switch	Silence: a disabled trigger, revoked auth, a dead script	Minutes
Daily digest	The slow drift a human should read about	Daily, 8:00

The digest's closing line: "No news from me tomorrow would itself be a signal. Check the triggers."

Limits, all of them visible

Every rate limit in the demo shows the visitor a live remaining count before they hit it: simulations per visitor and demo-wide, assistant questions per minute and per day. A limit someone discovers by silently failing is treated as a bug.

Where this would go inside Mentella

- **First:** point the same pipeline at the real hiring tracker behind a dry-run flag, and let it draft (not send) for a week while the team reads the Outbox.
- **Then:** extend the pattern to the other spreadsheet-tracked handoffs around onboarding: credentialing checklists, IT provisioning, first-week reminders.
- **Where systems have no API** (several core clinical and billing systems don't): treat the scheduled manual export as the interface, validate it loudly, and report on it. A working slice of that approach ships in this demo's repo.
- **The assistant grows with the handbook.** It only ever answers from documents the team controls, with citations, so growing it is writing docs, not training a model.

Try it yourself

Open <https://welcome-copilot.vercel.app>, click through the console, and ask the assistant one of the suggested questions. With the access code, press ► **Simulate a hire** and watch a real email go out in about thirty seconds.

Built with Google Apps Script, Next.js, Claude, and a healthy fear of silent failures.
Unofficial demo for an application to Mentella Health. All data fictional.